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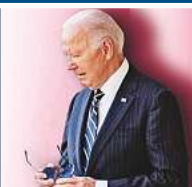
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Dubai launches initiative to attract 10,000 top influencers

Individuals to be given Golden Visa; relocation support, among other benefits

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE yesterday launched the first ever Creators HQ at Emirates Towers in Dubai as part of the three-day 1 Billion Followers Summit which began on Saturday, marking a major milestone for the global content creation industry. This initiative seeks to unite content creators and industry leaders worldwide, positioning the UAE as a prime destination for digital media. The Creators HQ aims to attract 10,000 influencers to the UAE "over the next period".

The HQ is designed to empower creators, amplify their impact, and establish sustainable frameworks for the booming creator economy. The initiative stems from the 'Content Creators Support Fund', launched under the directives of His Highness Sheikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, during the 1 Billion Followers Summit's second edition in 2024. The Dh150 million fund is dedicated to supporting creators, innovators, and creative initiatives.

Exclusive benefits

Designed as a full turn-key institution for content creators, the Creator HQ is set to host more than 300 events and workshops annually. It will cater to the evolving demands of the global creator economy, with members gaining access



AIRWALKER

Slackline athlete Jaan Roose walks between Jumeirah Emirates Towers on the opening day of '1 Billion Followers Summit'.

224m

the height of the 100-metre slackline between the towers

to exclusive benefits and services, such as assistance with UAE Golden Visa applications, relocation support, and company setup and registration.

Endorsed by top platforms

The Creators HQ launched with 100 members who represent the world's finest creators, as well as enablers and support-

ers of the content industry, from more than 20 countries. This initiative has been endorsed and supported by more than 15 of the world's most prominent names in the field of written or visual content, including Meta, TikTok, X, Spotter, Creator Now, Tube Filter, Epidemic Sound and the New Media Academy.

SEE ALSO P4

Demand for office staff on the rise in UAE

Roles being filled by professionals in late 20s or early 30s

DUBAI

BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

The UAE is seeing a surge in demand for office staff, fuelled by the influx of new companies setting up operations. This demand extends to HR professionals, admin roles, and customer service staff, ensuring smooth operations for these burgeoning businesses.

While AI and tech roles dominate the spotlight, office-based positions are quietly thriving. "Each new office in Dubai creates its own requirements," said a senior manager at a hiring firm.

Many roles are being filled by young professionals in their late 20s or early 30s, drawn from the growing

population of new residents in the UAE. Salary ranges for general office management, admin, and customer service roles hover between Dh4,000 and Dh8,000 per month. The market is also seeing a 15-20 per cent growth in these roles, according to Innovations Group CEO, Ravi Jethwani.

Startups and SMEs are increasingly outsourcing or hiring temporary staff to manage costs and maintain flexibility. Recruitment agencies are seeing high demand for temporary and project-based roles, with structured contracts becoming the norm, enhancing workforce stability.

An interesting shift is the growing participation of UAE nationals in private-sector roles. Many Emiratis are exploring temporary or contract positions, particularly in finance, HR, and IT, as pathways to permanent opportunities and skill development.

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NATION

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NATION

Now, take
driving
lessons in
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Riyadh calls for lifting Syria sanctions

TOP OFFICIALS FROM REGION AND EUROPE DISCUSS NATION'S RECOVERY

RIYADH

Saudi Arabia yesterday called for the lifting of sanctions on Syria after meetings with top diplomats from the Middle East and Europe that focused on the war-ravaged country's future.

"We stressed the importance of lifting unilateral and international sanctions imposed on Syria, as their continuation hinders the aspirations of the Syrian people to achieve development and reconstruction," Saudi Foreign Minister Prince Faisal Bin Farhan said after the talks concluded in Riyadh.

The agenda included a meeting of Arab officials as well as a broader gathering that also included Turkey, France, the European Union and the United Nations.

Syria's new leader Ahmad Al Sharaa is pushing for sanctions relief. His administration was represented at the Riyadh talks by Foreign Minister Asaad Al Shaibani.

The European Union's top diplomat, Kaja Kallas, said the 27-nation bloc could begin lifting sanctions if Syria's new rulers

took steps to form an inclusive government that protected minorities. Possible priorities for relief include "those sanctions that are hindering the building up of a country, access to banking services and all these things", Kallas told reporters in Riyadh.

German Foreign Minister Annalena Baerbock told reporters in Riyadh that her government wanted a "smart approach" that would enable aid to reach Syrians.

Riyadh's decision to host yesterday's talks "sends the message that Saudi Arabia wants to take the lead on coordinating the regional effort to support Syria's recovery," said Anna Jacobs, non-resident fellow at the Arab Gulf States Institute in Washington.

—AFP

SEE ALSO P9

The European Union's top diplomat, Kaja Kallas, said the 27-nation bloc could begin lifting sanctions if Syria's new rulers took steps to form an inclusive government.



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CEO White | P11

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